

Winlink Form Import

Pre-Activation Validation Checklist

Run this check once before each deployment season — and any time Winlink Express or its form templates are updated. Its purpose is to confirm that forms created in Winlink Express on the Windows station import cleanly into the Incident Management server and re-render correctly on the Pi. Catching a field-mapping change here, in a calm setting, prevents surprises during a real activation.

IMPORTANT: Winlink periodically updates its form templates, which can rename or move fields. A version that imported perfectly last season may map a field differently after an update. That is exactly what this check is for.

Validation Record

Performed by (name / callsign):		Date:	
Winlink Express version:		Forms version:	
Incident Mgmt server reachable at 192.168.50.1?	Y / N	Tester device:	

Part A — Setup (do once)

	STEP	RESULT	NOTES
☐	On the Windows station, confirm Winlink Express opens and you can reach the form templates (Message → Select Template).	P / F	
☐	Confirm a device on EMCOMM-NET can open the dashboard at http://192.168.50.1 and reach Winlink Form Import (ICS mode).	P / F	
☐	Confirm at least one test incident exists in the ICS Platform (so the import can be tagged to it).	P / F	

Part B — Validate ICS-213 (General Message)

	STEP	RESULT	NOTES
☐	In Express, open a new message and select the ICS-213 template. Fill every field with recognizable test text (e.g. To = "TEST OSC", Subject = "VALIDATION 213", a multi-line message, and an Approved-By name).	P / F	
☐	Click Submit , then in the message window right-click the RMS_Express_Form_*.xml attachment and Save it to a USB stick.	P / F	
☐	On a device on EMCOMM-NET, open Winlink Form Import and drop in the saved XML. Click Parse Form Data .	P / F	
☐	Confirm it reports "Detected an ICS-213 General Message form."	P / F	
☐	Check every field in the review grid against what you typed. Note any field that is blank, wrong, or listed under "Fields not automatically mapped."	P / F	

☐	Click Open in ICS form (print) . Confirm the ICS-213 re-renders on the Pi with your test data in the right places, and that it prints correctly.	P / F	
☐	Go back, choose the test incident and a direction, and click Archive to incident . Confirm the success message.	P / F	

Part C — Validate ICS-214 (Activity Log)

	STEP	RESULT	NOTES
☐	In Express, select the ICS-214 template. Enter a unit name, leader, operational period, two or three personnel, and several timestamped activity lines.	P / F	
☐	Submit, save the XML attachment, and import it on the Pi.	P / F	
☐	Confirm it reports "Detected an ICS-214 Activity Log form."	P / F	
☐	Check the header fields, and confirm the activity lines and personnel split into separate rows (not all jammed into one box).	P / F	
☐	Open in ICS form, confirm the ICS-214 re-renders and prints, then archive to the incident.	P / F	

Part D — Validate ICS-309 (Communications Log)

	STEP	RESULT	NOTES
☐	In Express, generate or fill an ICS-309 with several log entries (date/time, from, to, subject for each).	P / F	
☐	Save the XML (or copy the message text) and import it on the Pi.	P / F	
☐	Confirm it reports "Detected an ICS-309 Communications Log form."	P / F	
☐	In the review grid, open the Log Entries (raw) box and confirm the rows are present.	P / F	
☐	Open in ICS form. Confirm each log entry lands in its own row with Date/Time, From, To, and Subject in the correct columns. If everything piles into the Subject column, the delimiter differs — note it (see below).	P / F	
☐	Confirm it prints, then archive to the incident.	P / F	

TIP: If ICS-309 rows do not split correctly, the import still captured the data — you can correct the rows by hand in the ICS-309 page before printing. Record the exact format of the log block (tabs, spaces, or another separator) and report it so the parser can be tuned.

Part E — Confirm the Incident Record

	STEP	RESULT	NOTES
☐	Open the ICS Platform and the incident you tagged. Confirm all three archived forms (213, 214, 309) appear in the incident record.	P / F	
☐	Confirm each archived form shows the correct type, direction (sent/received), and summary.	P / F	

☐	If the server was ever unreachable during the test, confirm the local fallback copy was created and then successfully re-archived once the server was back.	P / F	
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Sign-Off

Result (circle one):	PASS — import validated	PASS WITH NOTES	FAIL — see notes
Field-mapping issues found / reported:			
Validated by (signature):		Date:	

Keep the completed checklist with the station documentation. Re-run after any Winlink Express or forms update. Reference: Complete User Manual, Chapter 24 (Winlink Form Import & Incident Archiving).